

Microsoft rushes security updates to address two vulnerabilities

Microsoft has issued urgent security updates for its products, including Edge, Teams, and Skype, to address two zero-day vulnerabilities linked to open source libraries. These vulnerabilities could result in crashes or, more concerning, arbitrary code execution.

One of the flaws, identified as CVE-2023-4863, stems from a heap buffer overflow issue in the WebP code library (libwebp). This vulnerability affects a range of browsers, including Safari, Mozilla Firefox, Microsoft Edge, Opera, and native Android web browsers, as well as apps like 1Password and Signal.

The second vulnerability, known as CVE-2023-5217, arises from a heap buffer overflow weakness in the VP8 encoding of the libvpx video codec library. This library plays a crucial role in VP8 and VP9 video encoding and decoding for desktop video players and streaming services like Netflix, YouTube, and Amazon Prime Video.

Microsoft acted swiftly to patch these vulnerabilities, focusing on products like Microsoft Edge, Microsoft Teams for Desktop, Skype for Desktop, and WebP Image Extensions. For users of WebP Image Extensions from the Microsoft Store, the security update will be automatically applied unless automatic updates are disabled.

These vulnerabilities were exploited in undisclosed spyware attacks, as reported by Apple Security Engineering and Architecture (SEAR), Google Threat Analysis Group (TAG), and the Citizen Lab. While details of these attacks remain elusive, it's clear that these vulnerabilities posed a real-world threat.

As cyber threats evolve, prompt software updates are essential. Microsoft's swift response demonstrates the commitment of tech giants to safeguard their products and users from emerging risks.

in turn, initiated the deployment of an open source rootkit known as 'r77'. This discovery raises concerns about the potential use of open source projects as a conduit for malware distribution.



remote attackers to take control of a victim's system via Discord while disabling vital security software.

One troubling command is '!rootkit', which activates the r77 rootkit on the compromised system. The r77 rootkit, maintained by bytecode77, is a 'fileless ring 3 rootkit' designed to conceal files and processes, either as a standalone tool or bundled with other software.

What sets this package apart is its reliance on publicly available components, providing low-stakes hacking groups with a straightforward path to launching supply chain attacks. This incident underscores the importance of rigorous vetting and verification in the open source ecosystem.

Critical 'ShellTorch' flaws found in TorchServe

Researchers have identified a set of critical vulnerabilities within TorchServe, a machine learning framework, which could potentially allow cyberattackers to compromise artificial intelligence (AI) models, leading to various undesirable outcomes. This revelation underscores the susceptibility of AI applications to open source bugs, even affecting tech giants like Google and Amazon.



Exploitation of these vulnerabilities could grant threat actors access to proprietary AI model data, enabling them to insert malicious models into production environments, manipulate machine learning results, and gain control over servers.

What's concerning is the widespread exposure of these vulnerabilities. Thousands of instances of vulnerable TorchServe software are accessible on the internet, posing a threat of unauthorised access and malicious actions, as reported by Oligo, the researchers behind the discovery.

The malevolent code concealed within 'node-hide-console-windows' resides in its `index.js` file. Upon execution, it fetches and automatically runs an executable known as 'DiscordRAT 2.0', a C#-based open source Trojan with over 40 commands that enable

TorchServe, maintained by Amazon and Meta, is an open source framework that deploys deep learning models using the PyTorch library. It is widely utilised by major companies such as Walmart, Amazon, Microsoft Azure, and Google Cloud.